Experiment 9

Student Name: Shivam Kumar **UID: 23BCS14207**
Branch: CSE **Section/Group: KRG 1B**
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Subject Name: System Design **Subject Code: 23CSH-314**

1. **Aim:** To design and analyze a scalable Ticket Booking System (like BookMyShow/Ticketmaster) that allows users to discover events, lock seats in real-time, manage bookings, and perform payment transactions efficiently using distributed system architecture.

2. **Objective:**

• To identify functional and non-functional requirements of a ticket booking system

• To design High Level Architecture (HLD) for event discovery and booking platforms

• To understand real-time distributed seat locking mechanisms

• To design microservices for search, booking, seats, and payments

• To study transaction execution and double-booking prevention mechanisms

• To understand scalability challenges in high-traffic ticketing systems

3. **Tools:** • Draw.io / Excalidraw – System design diagrams • MySQL / PostgreSQL – User & transaction data • Redis – Caching & real-time data • Kafka – Event streaming (bookings/alerts) • Load Balancer – Traffic distribution • WebSockets – Real-time seat updates • Microservices Architecture • Elasticsearch – Search indexing

4. System Requirements:

A. Functional Requirements:-

• Users should be able to search events by keyword, city, or date

• System should display detailed event info and interactive seat maps

• Users should be able to temporarily lock seats (TTL of 10 minutes)

• Users should execute bookings and process payments

• System should generate e-tickets (QR code + PDF)

B. Non-Functional Requirements:-

Scalability a. Support 100 million daily active users (DAU) b. Handle 95% Read / 5% Write traffic split

Consistency (CAP Theorem) a. Booking Path: Consistency > Availability (CP Model) b. Search Path: Availability > Consistency (AP Model)

Availability a. Event discovery should maintain 99.99% Uptime SLA

Latency a. Search and Event page loads < 200–300 ms b. Booking execution < 500 ms (P99)

Reliability a. Strict ACID transactions; no phantom reads or duplicate bookings

4. High Level Design (HLD):

System follows Microservices Architecture Main Components:

API Gateway a. Authentication (JWT) b. Authorization c. Routing d. Strict Rate Limiting (e.g., 10 req/min for seat locking)

User Service a. Registration & login b. User profile management c. User DB (PostgreSQL)

Search Service a. Queries Elasticsearch for rapid event discovery b. Uses Redis Cache for hot search results

Event & Seat Service a. Manages event metadata, venues, and shows b. Provides interactive seat maps (mapped to PostgreSQL)

Booking Service a. Acquires distributed locks via Redis Redlock b. Executes ACID transactions with optimistic locking c. Updates seat status to 'BOOKED'

Payment Service a. Integrates external gateways (Razorpay/Stripe) b. Enforces idempotency to ignore duplicate attempts

Notification Service a. Consumes Kafka messages asynchronously b. Dispatches Email/SMS/Push alerts

Ticket Generation Service a. Generates QR+PDF tickets and stores in S3

CDN (CloudFront) a. Edge caching for posters and static assets

6. Booking Flow (Step-by-Step):

User hits API Gateway where JWT and rate limits are checked

User searches events and views the interactive seat map

User selects a seat to book

Booking Service acquires Redis Redlock (10-minute TTL)

PostgreSQL ACID transaction begins to lock seat

Payment Gateway is called to process transaction

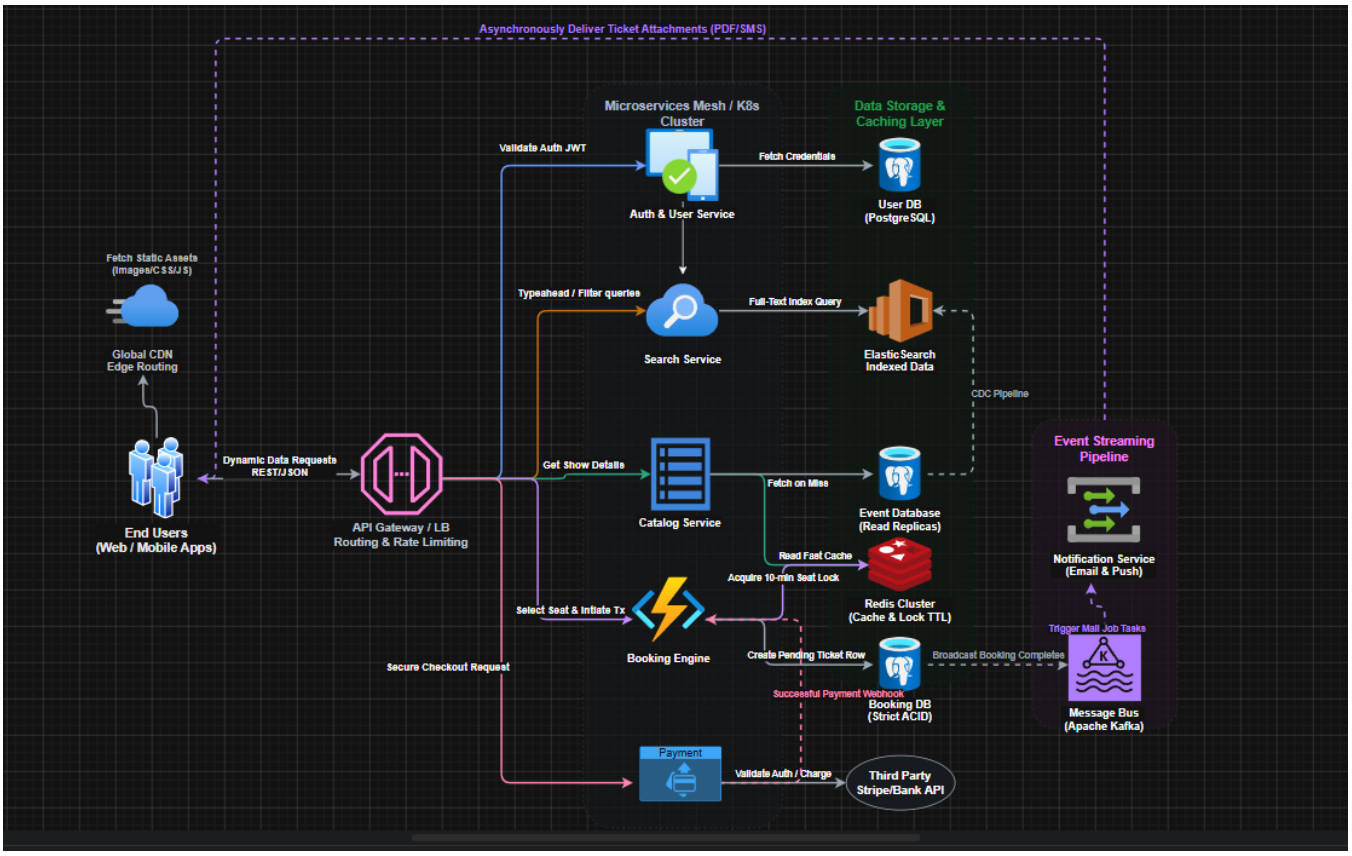
Upon success, seat status updated to 'BOOKED'

Kafka publishes booking-events message

Notification Service sends Email/SMS alerts

Ticket Gen Service creates QR/PDF ticket in S3

7. Scalability Solution: To support 100 million DAU: • Use Multi-Region Active-Active architecture with GeoDNS • Use Redis for aggressive caching of search and event details • Use CloudFront (CDN) to serve heavy static assets globally • Use PostgreSQL read replicas to offload 95% browse traffic • Use Elasticsearch for complex full-text and geo-spatial queries • Use Kafka to decouple non-blocking tasks (notifications/analytics) • Use Kubernetes (HPA/KEDA) for CPU and event-driven auto-scaling • Use API Gateway for centralized security (WAF) and control



8. Learning Outcomes (What I Have Learnt):

- Learned how high-scale ticket booking platforms are designed
- Understood real-time data streaming using Kafka
- Learned booking validation and ACID transaction execution flow
- Understood distributed seat locking mechanisms and TTLs
- Learned importance of consistency in payment and booking systems
- Understood microservices and scalability
- Learned how third-party payment gateways integrate with apps